

# BRAD GARD

KEYNOTE SPEAKER · MASTER ELECTRICIAN · TRAINING DIRECTOR, IBEW LOCAL 120

**BRADGARD.CA**
INFO@BRADGARD.CA
YOUTUBE.COM/@BRADGARD

## LEADERSHIP IS NOT GIVEN. IT IS EARNED.

### ABOUT

Brad Gard has spent over four decades in the electrical trade, on the tools since he was fourteen. Apprentice, journeyperson, foreperson, business owner, safety leader, and now Training Director at IBEW Local 120.

He speaks to industry, labour, and education audiences about the three things he has spent a career living: building the next generation of skilled trades, mentorship that changes real outcomes, and a safety culture people believe in instead of just comply with. His talks work on stage because they happened in the field first.

### THE KEYNOTES

#### EARNED, NOT GIVEN FLAGSHIP

Thirty-eight apprentices. One hundred and five Grade 8 students. One day that proved leadership is revealed through real responsibility, not handed out with a title.

#### FROM TOOLS TO TEACHING

What happens when your best tradespeople become your worst teachers, and how to fix it before twenty years of knowledge walks out the door.

#### ZERO INCIDENTS IS A CULTURE

Safety paperwork saves no one. Real prevention happens in a conversation you were not in the room for. You build the culture, or you wait for the incident that proves you did not.

#### THE TRADES IN CRISIS

The skilled trades shortage is not a pipeline problem. It is a perception problem, and the sector has been solving the wrong one for twenty years.

#### THE ARC FLASH STORY NEW

One live panel, one fireball, and the gear he almost skipped. A first-person account of the afternoon that proves current does not care about your plans.

#### FIRST ON THE SCENE NEW

A keynote for the people who train the public to act. Every bystander save stands on an instructor who was never in the room, and will never get the call.

Every talk runs as a keynote or a modular session, cut to your program length.

### THE PROOF · FEB 2026

| | |
|---|---|
| **38** | Apprentices who led the day |
| **105** | Grade 8 students mentored, one-to-one |
| **46%** | Female participation, vs a 4% industry baseline. 11.5x the average. |
| **60%** | Visible minority participation |
| **0** | Safety incidents |

### WHAT THE ROOM SAID

> *My son has not stopped talking about it. He thoroughly enjoyed the apprentice he was paired with.*
> PARENT, FEB 2026 PROGRAM

> *Even though I realized the trades might not be for me, I still had so much fun.*
> ELLA, GRADE 8 STUDENT

### WHO HE SPEAKS TO

Trade associations and unions · Apprenticeship and training conferences · Safety days and summits · Construction and industrial employers · Education and workforce-development audiences · First aid and CPR instructors

RECENT KEYNOTE · NETCO, CHARLEVOIX

### CREDENTIALS

309A ESA Master Electrician · NCSO Construction Safety Officer · CSA Z462 Electrical Safety · JHSC Parts 1 & 2 · COR Internal Auditor · EV Technician + Instructor · NETCO Leadership Excellence Award, 2026 · SDF ×5 Skills Development Fund rounds · IBEW Health & Welfare Trustee

## BOOK A KEYNOTE

bradgard.ca · info@bradgard.ca
See a talk: youtube.com/@bradgard